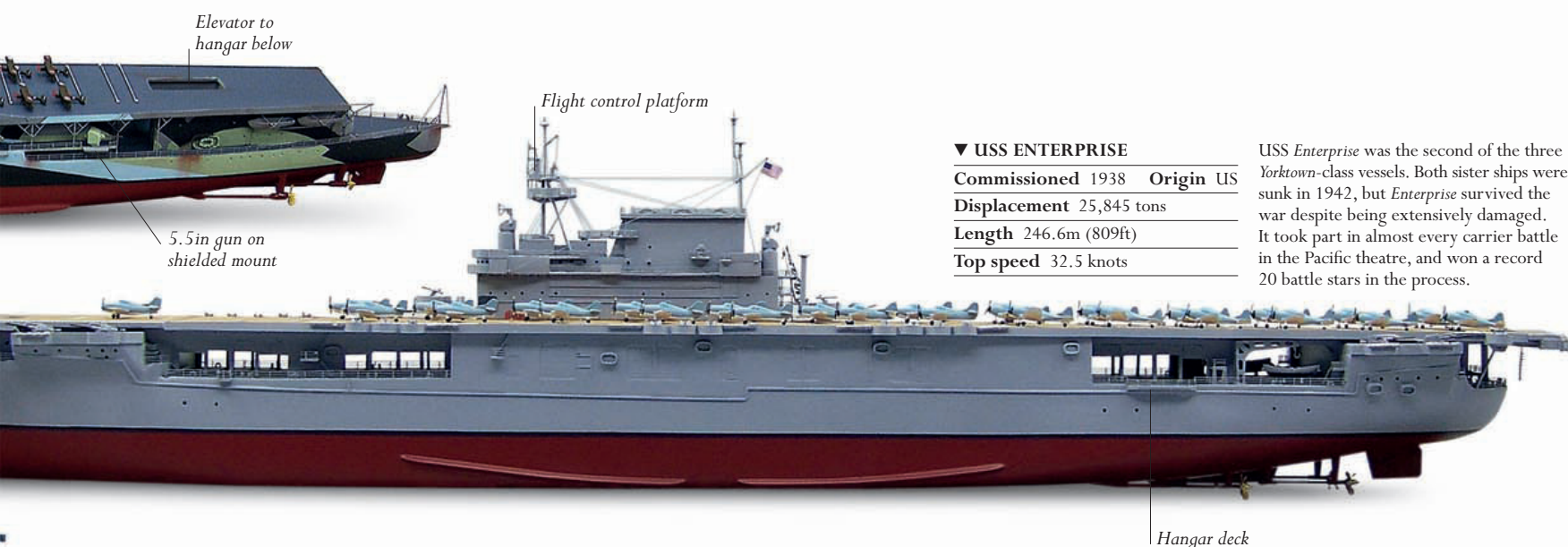
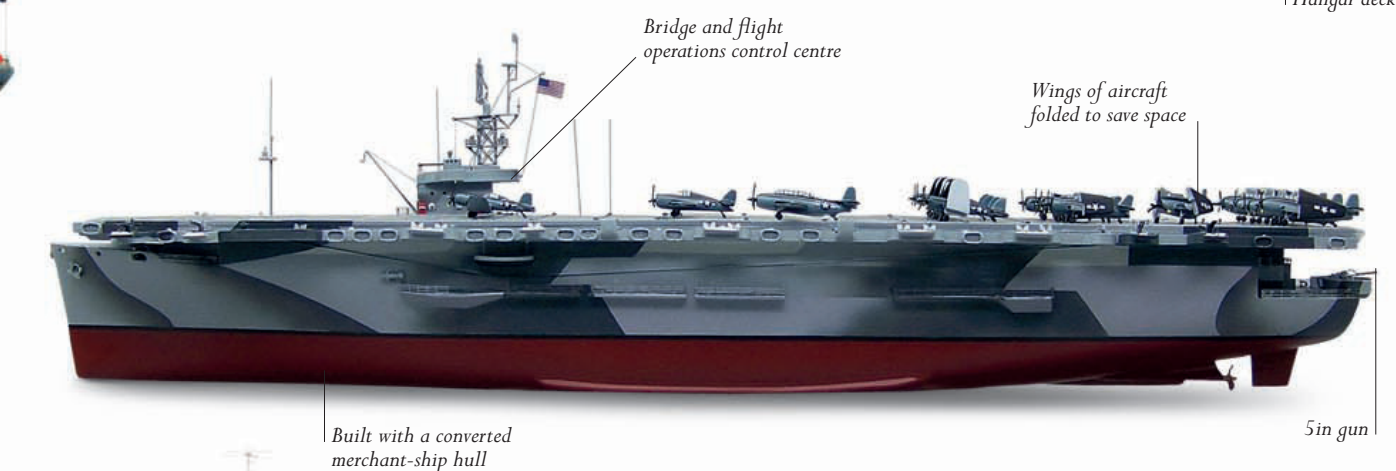


▼ **USS ENTERPRISE**

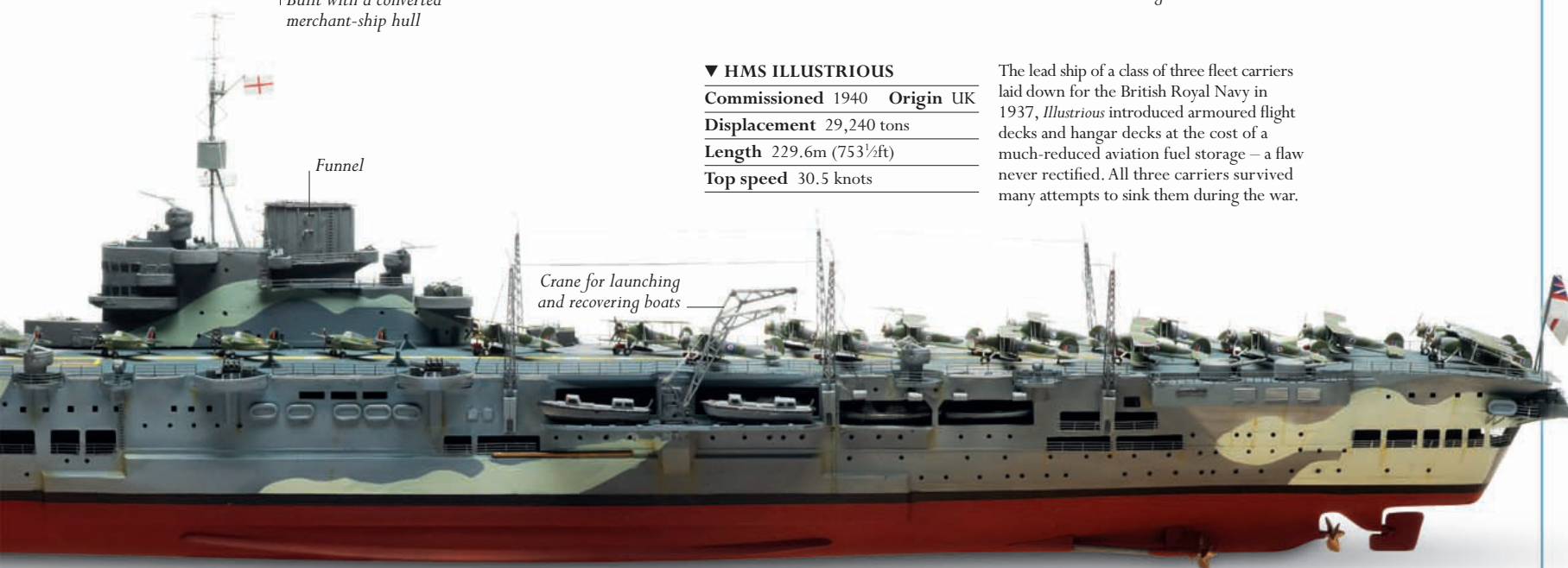
Commissioned	1938	Origin	US
Displacement	25,845 tons		
Length	246.6m (809ft)		
Top speed	32.5 knots		

USS *Enterprise* was the second of the three *Yorktown*-class vessels. Both sister ships were sunk in 1942, but *Enterprise* survived the war despite being extensively damaged. It took part in almost every carrier battle in the Pacific theatre, and won a record 20 battle stars in the process.

◀ **USS GUADALCANAL**

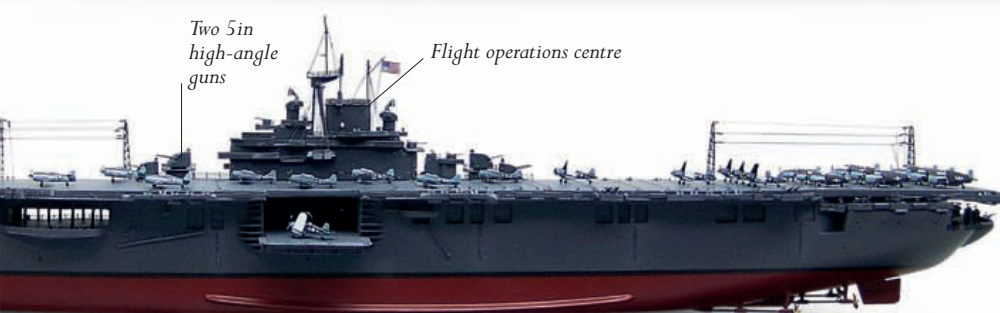
Commissioned	1943	Origin	US
Displacement	10,900 tons		
Length	156m (512¼ft)		
Top speed	19 knots		

One of the 50-strong *Casablanca* class of escort carriers, *Guadalcanal* was built for the US Navy by Henry Kaiser, in Vancouver, Canada. His shipyard used production-line methods that saw ships being completed and entering service in less than four months.

▼ **HMS ILLUSTRIOUS**

Commissioned	1940	Origin	UK
Displacement	29,240 tons		
Length	229.6m (753½ft)		
Top speed	30.5 knots		

The lead ship of a class of three fleet carriers laid down for the British Royal Navy in 1937, *Illustrious* introduced armoured flight decks and hangar decks at the cost of a much-reduced aviation fuel storage – a flaw never rectified. All three carriers survived many attempts to sink them during the war.

◀ **USS ESSEX**

Commissioned	1942	Origin	US
Displacement	34,880 tons		
Length	265.8m (872ft)		
Top speed	32.7 knots		

The 24 *Essex*-class fleet carriers at the core of the US Navy's Fast Carrier Task Force did more to win the war in the Pacific than any other ship. All survived, and – rebuilt with angled flight decks and other improvements – went on to form the basis of the post-war carrier fleet.